

013. Chapter 2 Verses 32-38

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.32

यदृच्छया चोपपन्नं स्वर्गद्वारमपावृतम् ।
सुखिनः क्षत्रियाः पार्थ लभन्ते युद्धमीदृशम् ॥ 32 ॥

yadṛcchayā copapannam
svargadvāramapāvṛtam |
sukhinaḥ kṣatriyāḥ pārtha
labhante yuddhamīdṛśam ||

- ◆ yadṛcchayā - of its own accord; ca - and; upapannam - come/arrived;
- ◆ svarga-dvāram - door to heaven; apāvṛtam - wide open;
- ◆ sukhinaḥ - happy; kṣatriyāḥ - warriors; pārtha - O Partha;
- ◆ labhante - gain; yuddham - war; īdṛśam - such.

Happy indeed are the kshatriyas, O Pārtha, to whom comes such a war, offering itself unsought, opening the gate to heaven.

VERSE 2.33

अथ चेतत्त्वमिमं धर्म्यं संग्रामं न करिष्यसि ।
ततः स्वधर्मं कीर्तिं च हित्वा पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥ ३३ ॥

atha cettvamimam dharmyam
saṅgrāmam na kariṣyasi |
tataḥ svadharmam kīrtim ca
hitvā pāpamavāpsyasi ||

- ◆ **atha** - but; **cet** - if; **tvam** - you; **imam** - this; **dharmyam** - righteous;
- ◆ **saṅgrāmam** - battle; **na** - not; **kariṣyasi** - will perform;
- ◆ **tataḥ** - then; **svadharmam** - own duty; **kīrtim** - fame; **ca** - and;
- ◆ **hitvā** - losing; **pāpam** - sin; **avāpsyasi** - will incur.

But if you do not fight this righteous war you would incur sin by abandoning your own duty, name, and fame.

VERSE 2.34

अकीर्तिं चापि भूतानि
कथयिष्यन्ति तेऽव्ययाम् ।
सम्भावितस्य चाकीर्ति
मरणदतिरिच्यते ॥ 34 ॥

akīrtiṃ cāpi bhūtāni
kathayiṣyanti te'vyayām |
sambhāvitasya cākīrtir
maraṇādatiricyate ||

- ◆ **akīrtim** - infamy; **ca** - and; **api** - also; **bhūtāni** - people;
- ◆ **kathayiṣyanti** - will speak; **te** - of you; **avyayām** - long-standing/perpetual;
- ◆ **sambhāvitasya** - for an honorable man; **ca** - and; **akīrtiḥ** - infamy;
- ◆ **marañāt** - than death; **atiricyate** - is worse.

And also, these people will speak of your everlasting dishonor, and to one who is honored, dishonor is worse than death.

VERSE 2.35

भयाद्द्रणादुपरतं मंस्यन्ते त्वां महारथाः ।
येषां च त्वं बहुमतो भूत्वा यास्यसि लाघवम् ॥ 35 ॥

bhayādraṇāduparatam
maṁsyante tvāṁ mahārathāḥ |
yeṣāṁ ca tvam bahumato
bhūtvā yāsyasi lāghavam ||

- ◆ **bhayāt** - out of fear; **raṇāt** - from battle; **uparatam** - withdrawn;
- ◆ **maṁsyante** - will think; **tvām** - you; **mahārathāḥ** - great chariot-warriors;
- ◆ **yeṣām** - of whom; **ca** - and; **tvam** - you; **bahumataḥ** - highly esteemed;
- ◆ **bhūtvā** - having been; **yāsyasi** - will go to; **lāghavam** - insignificance/lightness.

Moreover, those great warriors from whom you received honor formerly would think that you turned away from battle out of fear, and regard you with little respect hereafter.

VERSE 2.36

अवाच्यवादांश्च बहून्वदिष्यन्ति तवाहिताः ।
निन्दन्तस्तव सामर्थ्यं ततो दुःखतरं नु किम् ॥ 36 ॥

avācyavādāṃśca bahūn
vadiṣyanti tavāhitāḥ |
nindantastava sāmāthyam
tato duḥkhataram nu kim ||

- ◆ **avācyavādān** - unspeakable words; **ca** - and; **bahūn** - many;
- ◆ **vadiṣyanti** - will say; **tava** - your; **ahitāḥ** - enemies;
- ◆ **nindantaḥ** - slandering; **tava** - your; **sāmāthyam** - prowess;
- ◆ **tataḥ** - than that; **duḥkhataram** - more painful; **nu** - indeed; **kim** - what.

Your enemies belittle your ability, and in various ways speak words of ill-fame and shame about you. What is there more painful than this?

VERSE 2.37

हतो वा प्राप्स्यसि स्वर्गं जित्वा वा भोक्ष्यसे महीम् ।
तस्मादुत्तिष्ठ कौन्तेय युद्धाय कृतनिश्चयः ॥ ३७ ॥

hato vā prāpsyasi svargam
jītvā vā bhokṣyase mahīm |
tasmāduत्तिष्ठ kaunteya
yuddhāya kṛtaniścayaḥ ||

- ◆ **hataḥ** - slain; **vā** - or; **prāpsyasi** - you will gain; **svargam** - heaven;
- ◆ **jītvā** - conquering; **vā** - or; **bhokṣyase** - you will enjoy; **mahīm** - the earth;
- ◆ **tasmāt** - therefore; **uttiṣṭha** - arise; **kaunteya** - O son of Kunti;
- ◆ ◆ **yuddhāya** - for battle; **kṛtaniścayaḥ** - determined.

If you are killed in the battle, you will go to heaven; if you win, you will enjoy the earth. Therefore arise, O son of Kunti, resolved to fight.

VERSE 2.38

सुखदुःखे समे कृत्वा लाभालाभौ जयाजयौ ।
ततो युद्धाय युज्यस्व नैवं पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥ 38 ॥

sukhaduḥkhe same kṛtvā
lābhālābhau jayājayau |
tato yuddhāya yujyasva
naivam pāpamavāpsyasi ||

- ◆ **sukha-duḥkhe** - in pleasure and pain; **same** - equal/alike; **kṛtvā** - making;
- ◆ **lābha-alābhau** - in gain and loss; **jaya-ajayau** - in victory and defeat;
- ◆ **tataḥ** - then; **yuddhāya** - for battle; **yujyasva** - engage;
- ◆ **na** - not; **evam** - thus; **pāpam** - sin; **avāpsyasi** - you will incur.

**Having an equal mind in pain and pleasure, gain and loss,
victory and defeat, engage in battle and thereby you will not
incur sin.**